



FIELDSCHOLAR

A Global Learning Companion

Project Overview

FieldScholar is a mobile-first platform for study abroad, experiential learning, field research, and university-sponsored travel. It brings program logistics, student support, safety, academic fieldwork, and faculty administration into one program-specific environment while complementing Canvas, email, and other institutional systems.

CURRENT PLATFORM STATE

Functional pilot

A live, configurable student/faculty experience that can support a faculty-led program end to end.

Institutional architecture

A multi-institution, multi-program domain and membership layer implemented and validated in the development codebase.

Protected pilot

The existing pilot remains intact; platform-expansion work is isolated from the production pilot and its data.

WHAT FIELDSCHOLAR BRINGS TO A PROGRAM

Program logistics

Schedules, housing, trips, maps, meeting points, program resources, and in-country information.

Safety & support

Emergency contacts, direct faculty communication, the student-facing I AM SAFE action, and voluntary one-time location sharing.

Academic fieldwork

Field notes, site observations, guided reflections, course resources, and place-based learning activities.

Faculty / administration

Program setup, student records, homestays, itinerary management, participant tools, and safety content.

CURRENT FIELD SCHOLAR CAPABILITIES

The current pilot is designed around the day-to-day needs of students and faculty while they are away from campus. The interface is mobile-first and can also be used in a desktop browser.

Restricted access

Approved participants only. Student and faculty/admin paths are separated, and administrative tools require an additional faculty verification step.

Safety Center

Emergency contacts and the student-only I AM SAFE action. Tapping it opens a prefilled WhatsApp message to the configured program contact without requiring a backend write or location tracking.

Student home

Course tools, housing and stay information, itinerary, notes, guided reflections, program guide, maps, and direct communication pathways.

One-time location sharing

A separate student-initiated action can share the current location once, after confirmation. FieldScholar does not continuously track students in the background.

Faculty/admin tools

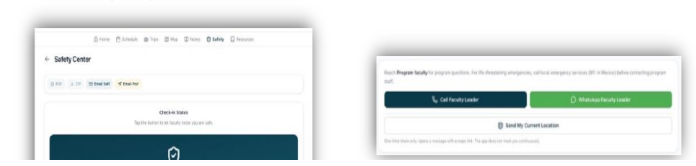
Program configuration, student records, homestays, itinerary editing, emergency and safety content, arrival roster, participant export, and related operational tools.

Notes & reflections

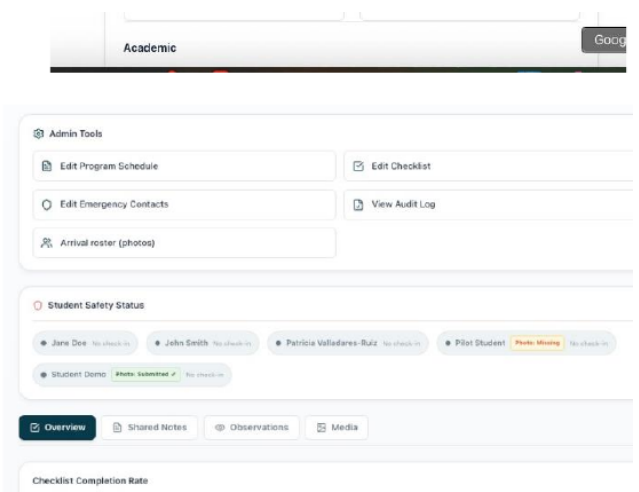
Students can create field notes and complete guided reflection activities that connect program mobility with experiential learning.

THE PRODUCT IN USE

- "I am Safe" check-in (one-tap confirmation used when requested)
- Emergency Contacts



Student Safety Center



Faculty dashboard

MULTI-INSTITUTION PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE

FieldScholar is being developed as one configurable platform rather than as separate codebases for individual programs. Its canonical hierarchy is:

INSTITUTION → PROGRAM → COHORT → MEMBERSHIP / USER → ROLE → DATA

IMPLEMENTED AND VALIDATED PLATFORM LAYER

The platform-expansion branch includes the institutional foundation needed to move beyond a single-program pilot, while leaving the live pilot unchanged.

Membership API & tenant isolation Institution-scoped access, membership create/suspend/remove operations, and atomic audit records.	Multi-program / cohort isolation Persistence and authorization checks that separate users and data across programs and cohorts.
Roster import CSV validation and secure bulk enrollment of program participants.	Program & cohort creation Authorized server-side creation with audit records.
Institution provisioning Operator-only institution and first-admin provisioning, plus institutional-context resolution.	Institution-scoped administration An administrative workflow for creating and managing programs, cohorts, and participant rosters within an institutional context.

ARCHITECTURAL PRINCIPLES

- One core codebase with institution- and program-specific configuration rather than separate forks.
- Server-side tenant isolation, role-based permissions, and a secure backend as the authoritative source of persistent data.
- Voluntary, event-based location sharing; FieldScholar does not use continuous location tracking.
- Preservation of a stable pilot while institutional architecture is developed and validated separately.

Pilot: fieldscholar.app

Info: about.fieldscholar.app

Designed and developed by [Patricia Valladares-Ruiz](#)